PROHORI: crack width in millimetres from a phone photo, with a calibrated "refuse when unsure" gate and a recapture agent

Technical report, OpenCV AI Competition 2026 (Overall, Best Use of COOL, Agentic Vision). Solo entry: Hozaifa, University of Dhaka.
Live endpoint: https://184-194-241-186.sslip.io. Code: https://github.com/hozaifa1/prohori (Apache-2.0).
Every number below is copied from a file in the repository; the file is named next to it.

Terms used throughout. "Certified (green)" is the strict tier. "Indicative (amber)" is the looser tier. A crack "passes the gate" if it is green or amber. "Refused" means no number is endorsed.

1 Abstract

PROHORI measures the width of a concrete crack from one phone photo that also shows a printed ChArUco board. OpenCV 5 finds the board, flattens the wall plane to a known scale and reads the width from grey levels. A gate calibrated with conformal risk control labels each crack **certified (green)**, **indicative (amber)** or **refused**, and an agent turns the gate's reasons into the next action: move closer, hold steady, re-light, reposition the board, accept, accept with a wider interval, or hand the case to an engineer who must approve it. It runs on one AWS Graviton4 instance (c8g.large) with the COOL AMI (OpenCV 5.1.0-dev, KleidiCV 0.7.0 HAL).
Headline results, all on data held out from tuning:
(1) width error on 8 held-out photos of a printed test panel: MAE 0.070 mm over 63 cracks, 0.056 mm over the 41 that pass the gate (`eval/results/width_eval.md`);
(2) on held-out photos, 3.2 % of certified (green) readings and 11.5 % of readings passing at the amber level are wrong, with 25.8 % and 38.7 % of cracks passing; the 90 % interval covers 91.5 % of readings (`eval/results/gate_report.md`);
(3) in a pre-registered simulator (100 held-out episodes), an AI agent (Amazon Nova Lite) behind a code-side fact-check recovers 88 % of compound-failure captures within three actions against 62 % for fixed rules (+25.0 points, 95 % CI +12.5 to +37.5); that equals the 88 % of a label rule written as plain code, so the gain comes from enforcing written rules and checking the wording, not from better reasoning. 99 % of its instructions cite a measured number with no wrong number or claim (rules 91 %, the same model without the fact-check 54 %). Claude Haiku 4.5 was not evaluated (section 6; `eval/results/agent_ablation.md`);
(4) the COOL AMI runs the full workload on Graviton4 and ties the stock pip wheel (0.994x end to end at 4 threads after optimisation), and a developer agent cut per-frame latency by 23.2 % and cost per 1,000 frames by 13.0 % with bit-identical output (`eval/results/cool_agentloop/README.md`).
There is no field validation: all real photos are of one printed panel taken with one phone.

2 Problem and impact

Context. On 24 April 2013 the Rana Plaza building near Dhaka collapsed and 1,134 people died; cracks in its walls had been reported the day before. Bangladesh's garment factories have since been inspected under the Accord and the RMG Sustainability Council. Their reporting (as recorded in `docs/ENTRY_PROHORI.md`; not re-verified here) lists 93,576 hazards found in initial inspections of 1,755 factories and 665 of roughly 1,800 factories fully remediated, with inspector availability named as the bottleneck.

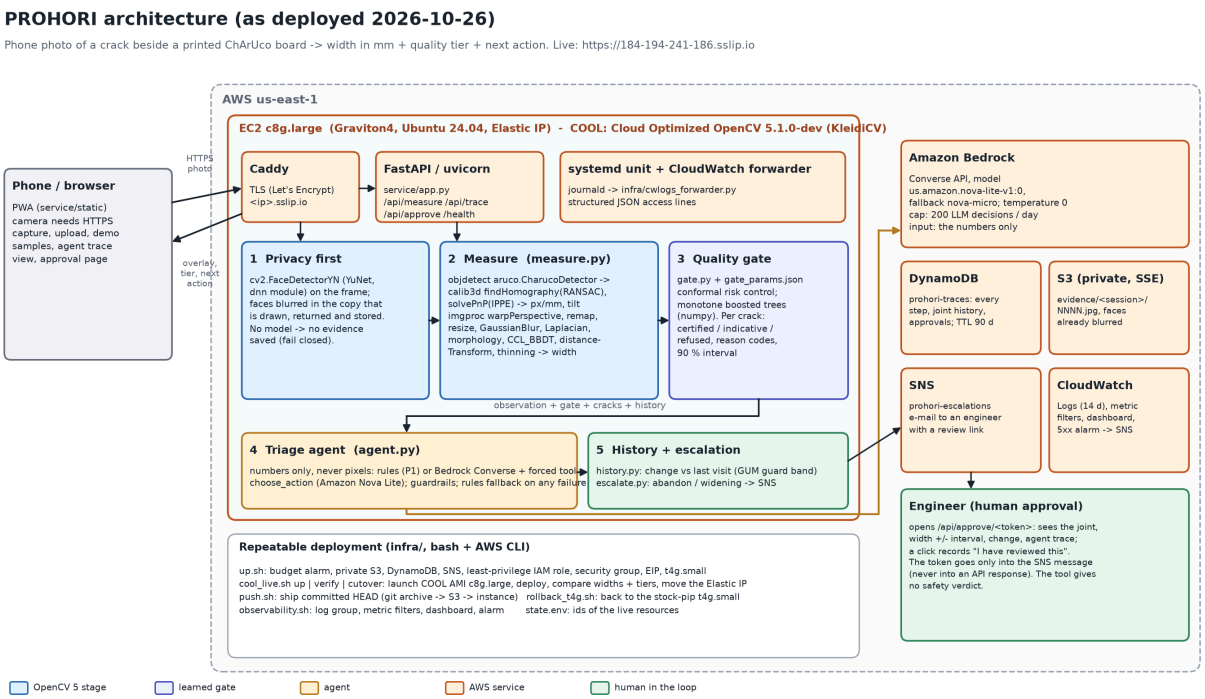
What is measured in practice. Crack width is usually judged by eye or with a plastic crack-comparator card. ACI 224R-01 Table 4.1 gives tolerable widths for reinforced concrete under service load as a durability guide: 0.41 mm (dry air), 0.30 mm (humid air, soil), 0.18 mm (de-icing chemicals), 0.15 mm (seawater), 0.10 mm (water-retaining) (`research/ADDENDUM.md`, corrected against the table). Dhaka is humid, so the

decisions that matter sit at 0.3 to 0.5 mm, where a phone photo gives about 3 to 15 pixels per millimetre. A LiDAR rig measured against a microscope reports 15 to 34 % relative error below 0.5 mm (Deng et al. 2026, `research/LITERATURE.md` S8).

Users. Site engineers and inspectors in garment and residential buildings who need a repeatable number, an honest error bar, and a record of how it changed since the last visit. The first use is a walk-through with a phone and a printed A4 sheet.

Why "refuse when unsure" is the core idea. A thin crack photographed from too far, with blur or at a steep angle, still produces a confident-looking number. A wrong millimetre figure is worse than none, because it may be filed as a record. PROHORI therefore reports a number only when a gate, calibrated on held-out data, says how often such a number is wrong. When the gate refuses, the agent says what to change. PROHORI does not decide whether a building is safe; ACI itself warns that these widths are not a reliable indication of corrosion. Every escalation says so and needs a named engineer's confirmation.

3 System overview



Architecture as deployed 2026-10-26

Request path: phone (PWA over HTTPS, required for the camera), Caddy with Let's Encrypt on `<ip>.sslip.io`, FastAPI. Then, in order: face redaction, measurement, quality gate, triage agent, history and escalation. State goes to DynamoDB (traces, joint history, approvals) and S3 (evidence images, faces already blurred). Escalations go to SNS. Logs and a 5xx alarm go to CloudWatch. The Python package `src/prohori/` is 7,383 lines and calls OpenCV directly; there is no deep segmentation network in the product path.

OpenCV 5 in the product path (verified by reading the call sites; `cv2.ximgproc` is not used, so the contrib package is not needed on COOL):

Module	Calls	Used for	Where
objdetect	aruco.CharucoDetector.detectBoard, FaceDetectorYN.create	find the 7x5 ChArUco board (24 inner corners); detect faces before storage	measure.py:123, 228, redact.py:96
calib3d	findHomography (RANSAC), solvePnP (IPPE), Rodrigues, cornerSubPix	image to board millimetres, tilt, sub-pixel corners	measure.py:243-264
imgproc	warpPerspective, remap, resize (INTER_AREA), GaussianBlur, Laplacian, Sobel, filter2D, medianBlur, erode/dilate/morphologyEx, connectedComponentsWithStatsWithAlgorithm (BBDT), distanceTransform, findContours	rectification, crack locator, sharpness and glare measures, mask quality checks, width profiles	measure.py
imgcodecs, core	imdecode, imencode, array arithmetic	JPEG in, annotated overlay out	service/app.py:225
dnn	YuNet ONNX model run by FaceDetectorYN	face redaction	models/ (OpenCV Zoo, MIT)

4 Measurement method

Pipeline (`src/prohori/measure.py`).

1. Detect the board on a grey copy of at most 2,000 px, refine corners at full resolution, fit a homography from image to board millimetres, and a pose for the tilt angle. At least 6 corners are required; without them no number is produced.
2. Rectify the page at low resolution and locate dark, thin, elongated components. Then rectify a tight region around each crack at full resolution, at no less than native pixels per millimetre.
3. Skeletonise the crack and sample the grey-level profile across it at every station along the skeleton. Estimate the width from the profile: a half-maximum width with a closed-form correction for Gaussian blur, blended continuously with an area-conserving estimate for cracks that are not resolved. The smoothing scale follows the blur measured from the board edges. The width is the median over stations.

Widths come from grey levels, not mask edges, because even the best crack segmenter agrees with human labels on the exact centreline pixel only 16.2 % of the time (OmniCrack30k, `research/LITERATURE.md` S10). A distance-transform estimator on exact rectangles also has a constant +1.00 px bias (`research/ADDENDUM.md`), which is removed in closed form.

Reference and truth. The test object is an A4 sheet with the board and eight printed strokes of 0.3, 0.4, 0.5, 0.75, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0 and 3.0 mm (`data/print/`). Toner spreads on paper, so the truth is the nominal width plus 2b, with b measured from the printed board squares: b_y = 0.0137 mm, giving **U_ref = +-0.009 mm** on the reference (`research/WIDTH_AUTORESEARCH.md` section 3). Errors below that are not meaningful. Photoreal renders with exact truth (500, built from third-party textures and crack masks) are the second source.

Width autoresearch. The estimator was tuned by an agent loop under rules written before the first run: objective J = 0.5 x panel MAE + 0.5 x render MAE on the TUNE split only; keep a change if J falls by at least 0.2 % and no guard rail trips (no thin-crack metric worse by more than 10 %, certified-only MAE not worse than the old estimator by more than 10 %, krkCMd resolution stability, coverage); one change per iteration; the gate frozen. Splits were frozen first: panel 14 TUNE photos and 8 TEST photos, renders 300 and 200. The TEST split is reachable only through a script that refuses to run twice. 51 iterations were logged (`eval/runs/width_autoresearch/log.tsv`). Two points from the log matter. After 15 iterations the truth was corrected

for toner bleed and the loop restarted from the old estimator, because part of the earlier gain was the estimator learning the bleed. A single-view radial-distortion correction was also tried and failed (panel MAE 0.0758 to 0.0842 mm), so it was not adopted.

Held-out result (`eval/results/width_eval.md`, produced once after the configuration was frozen; truth is the toner-corrected panel width or the exact render width):

Set	n	MAE mm [95 % CI]	MRE	P95 mm
Panel photos, all gate states	63	0.070 [0.048, 0.098]	7.4 %	0.209
Panel photos, cracks passing the gate	41	0.056 [0.042, 0.074]	3.9 %	0.143
Panel photos, cracks under 0.5 mm	16	0.055 [0.035, 0.077]	14.7 %	0.124
Renders, all gate states	162	0.098 [0.080, 0.119]	9.0 %	0.344

Against the pre-registered tiers (published bars from Hassouna et al. 2026 and Deng et al. 2026, `research/METRICS.md`): on all gate states the "Floor" is met for MAE (at most 0.09 mm), MRE and the thin-crack bin, and not for the coefficient of variation at 0.5 mm and above (7.0 % against 5.8 %). On cracks that pass the gate every Floor criterion is met. The "Target" (MAE 0.05 mm, P95 0.10 mm) is not met in either case. These bars come from different data and conditions, so they are context, not a head-to-head comparison.

The 2.0 and 3.0 mm specimens are under-read by 0.162 and 0.144 mm; the notes trace this to scale extrapolation from the 140 mm board to specimens up to 234 mm away, not to the estimator. The gain over the previous estimator is clear on renders (MAE 0.121 to 0.098 mm, -19 %) and small on real photos (0.075 to 0.070 mm, -7 %, inside the intervals). Thin cracks did not improve on real photos (0.053 to 0.055 mm).

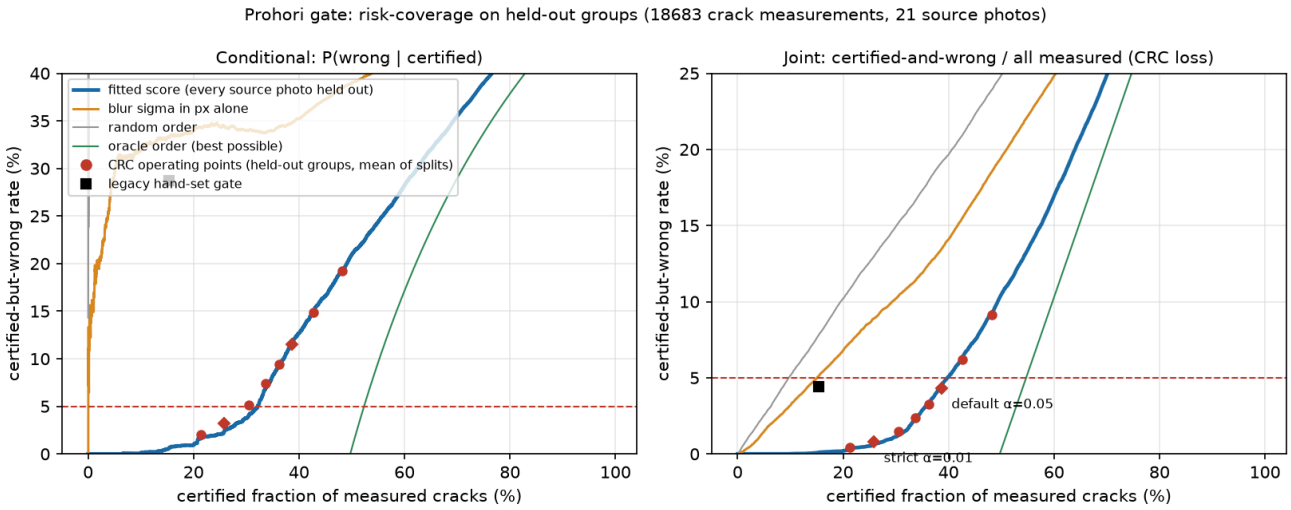
5 Calibrated quality gate

What it decides. For each crack, a model predicts how large the error will be relative to a tolerance, from observations the pipeline already computes (corners found, px/mm, blur, tilt, glare, noise, crack width, estimator disagreement, mask checks). A reading is **wrong** if it is off by more than max(0.05 mm, 10 % of the width). Model: monotone-constrained gradient-boosted trees (depth 3, 100 trees), so more blur or tilt can never improve a score. Mask quality checks (width blow-up, holes, fragmentation) follow Deng et al. 2026.

Calibration. The 29 photos of one sheet form 21 source groups. Each was degraded 120 ways (tilt, downscale, blur, glare, noise, JPEG), giving 2,584 captures and 18,683 crack measurements, of which 49.8 % are wrong by the definition above (the degradations are severe on purpose). Conformal risk control (Angelopoulos et al., ICLR 2024) picks the score threshold so that the expected share of certified-and-wrong cracks per capture stays under a level alpha. Two levels are shipped:

Tier	alpha_cal	Mean held-out CRC risk	Cracks passing	Wrong, given passing
Certified (green)	0.01	0.74 %	25.8 %	3.2 % (about 97 in 100 within tolerance)
Indicative (amber), passing at green or amber	0.05	4.30 %	38.7 %	11.5 % (about 88 in 100 within tolerance)
Refused				no number endorsed

Source: `eval/results/gate_report.md` section 4, means over 100 random splits that hold out 6 source photos. The capture tier is the best tier among its cracks. In the API, `cracks_certified` and the boolean `certified` count cracks passing at the amber level or better; the `tier` field distinguishes green from amber.



Risk-coverage of the gate on held-out groups

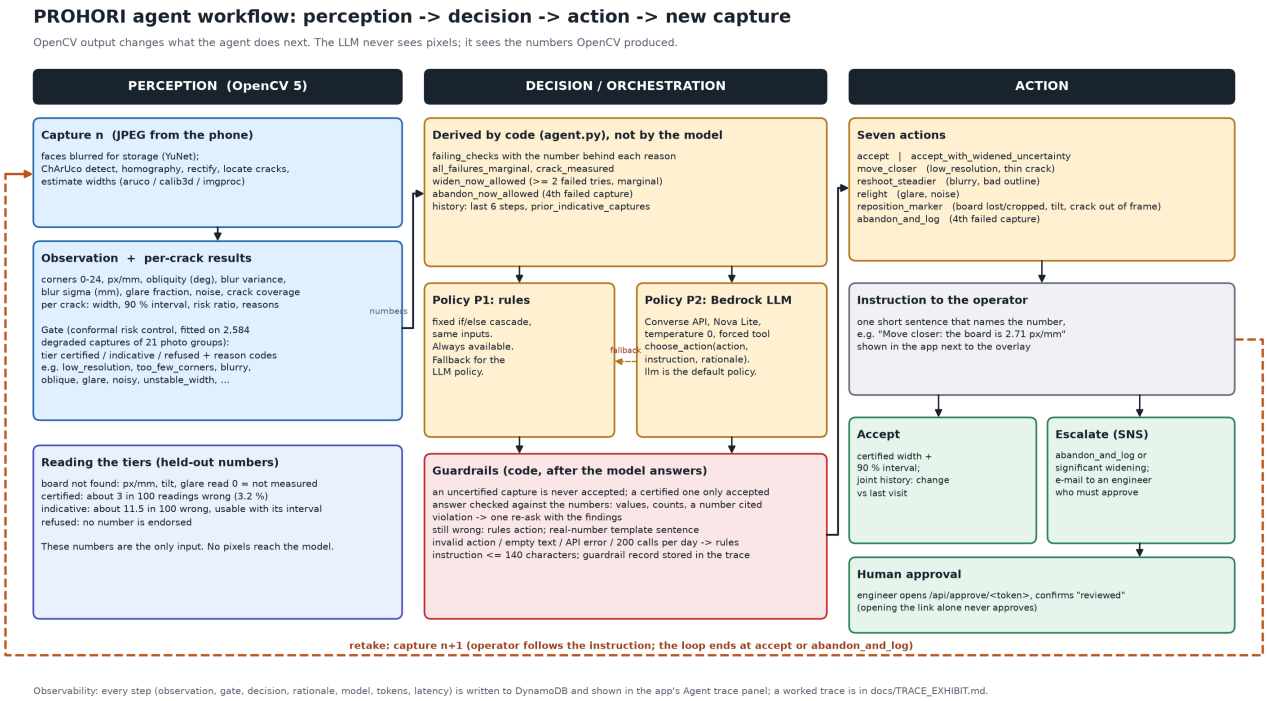
Interval. Each reading carries a 90 % conformal interval (Mondrian cells by measured-width bin and pass or flag). Held-out coverage over all readings is 91.5 % (5th to 95th percentile of splits: 86.2 to 96.9 %); among passing readings 91.8 %; median half-width of passing readings 0.179 mm. By true width: 0.3 mm 86.3 %, 0.4 mm 93.2 %, 0.5 mm 94.1 %, 0.75 mm 91.9 %, 1.0 mm 90.2 %, 1.5 mm 96.1 %, 2.0 mm 90.5 %, 3.0 mm 89.5 %. Only the 0.3 mm bin is clearly under 90 %. The previous heuristic interval covered 63.5 % at 2.0 mm.

Leave-one-photo-out. Holding each source photo out once, on the original undegraded photos 53.6 % of cracks pass at the amber level or better and 10.0 % of those are wrong.

What is guaranteed, and what is not.

- The CRC theorem bounds expected risk for exchangeable calibration and test data. Our 2,584 captures come from 21 photos, so they are not exchangeable across photos. The level was therefore chosen on grouped splits ("meta-calibrated"), and the evidence is empirical. At alpha_cal 0.05 the mean held-out risk is 4.30 %, and the risk is within alpha in 69 of 100 splits (76 of 100 at alpha_cal 0.01). A group-level CRC at 5 % would need more than 21 photos (slack 1/22 = 4.5 %).
- In time-contiguous blocks of photos the amber tier did worse: held-out risk up to 6.09 % in one block and P(wrong | passing) up to 27.2 % in another (`gate_report.md` section 4).
- No claim is made for new walls, textures, lighting or phones. Wrongness is judged against the printed nominal width; scored against the toner-corrected width, the amber-level risk is 3.80 %.
- The deployed gate has no per-feature threshold: any single feature alone "always passes" (`gate_report.md` section 7). A distance-from-board feature was tested under a pre-registered rule and not added (no measurable gain); a hard distance rule failed the no-harm test.

6 Agent: from OpenCV numbers to the next action



Agent workflow: perception, decision, action

Design. The agent never sees pixels. Its input is a JSON of numbers OpenCV produced: corners found, px/mm, tilt, blur, glare, noise, per-crack widths, intervals and reasons, the gate tier, the last six steps, and flags derived by code (`failing_checks`, `widen_now_allowed`, `abandon_now_allowed`). It answers with one forced tool call, `choose_action`, naming one of **seven actions**: `accept`, `accept_with_widened_uncertainty`, `move_closer`, `reshoot_steadier`, `relight`, `reposition_marker`, `abandon_and_log`. It also writes a one-sentence instruction for the operator, shown beside the overlay. Policy P1 is a fixed rule cascade; policy P2 is an LLM on Amazon Bedrock; policy P2g is the same LLM behind the guardrail below. The live default is `llm` (P2g): Nova Lite, then Nova Micro if that call fails, then the rules policy. The rules policy is always available as the fallback.

Guardrails in code, deployed (`src/prohori/agent.py`, live build `b3e9907`): an uncertified capture can never be accepted; a certified capture is only accepted (one optional retake if it is only amber); an invalid action, an empty text or an API error falls back to the rules policy; at most 200 LLM decisions run per day. Each answer is then checked against the observation: every number must match a measured value, "all cracks certified" must match the counts, the text must cite one measured number, and the action must not break a hard rule of the prompt. On any violation the model is asked once more with the findings. A still-wrong action is replaced by the rules policy's action; a still-wrong sentence is replaced by a template filled with the real numbers. The check is code, not a second model, and the stored trace records what the model first said and why it was sent back.

Human control. The agent can ask for an escalation (the fourth failed capture, or a joint that widens by more than the combined measurement uncertainty). It only sends a message through SNS. A named engineer opens `/api/approve/<token>`, reads the case, and presses a button that records "I have reviewed this". Opening the link approves nothing (mail scanners fetch links), and the token never appears in an API response or trace, so the person taking the photo cannot approve their own escalation.

A trace where OpenCV output changes the next action (`docs/TRACE_EXHIBIT.md`; live endpoint, 2026-10-26 15:08 UTC, build `b3e9907`, session `exhibit-20261026T150829`, Nova Lite behind the guardrail):

	Step 0	Step 1 (after the instruction)
OpenCV: corners, px/mm at cracks	24 of 24, **2.71**	24 of 24, **7.98**
Gate	refused, 0 of 8 cracks pass, `low_resolution`	certified (green) capture, 5 of 8 cracks pass (green or amber), no reasons
Agent action	**`move_closer`**	**`accept`**
Instruction	"Move closer: the board is 2.71 px/mm, a 0.5 mm crack needs about 10."	"Accept the capture: 5 out of 8 cracks are certified."
Guardrail	clean, no re-ask	first answer rejected (said "all cracks are certified", cited no number), re-ask fixed it

The only thing wrong in step 0 is a number OpenCV computed. If it had shown a lost board, a steep angle or a soft picture, the same code path would have produced `reposition_marker`, `reshoot_steadier` or `relight` (`docs/FAILURE_GALLERY.md`). An earlier recording of the same two photos, made before the guardrail existed (03:08 UTC, session `exhibit-20261026T030809`), showed two wrong sentences from the same model: "a 1.58 mm crack needs about 2.5 px/mm" at 2.71 measured, and "all cracks are certified" when 3 of 8 were flagged. The guardrail catches both kinds. It does not judge whether the advice is good, and the gate in step 1 is per crack: 3 of 8 cracks are still flagged.

Ablation. A pre-registered simulator study (`research/AGENT_PREREG.md`, written before any policy run): 100 held-out episodes of capture failures (single causes, compound causes, hopeless, constrained), operators who ignore an instruction 10 % of the time, paired common random numbers, 95 % bootstrap intervals. The label rule P* (plain code written from the same reasoning as the simulator) is the ceiling.

Recovery within 3 actions	n	Random P0	Rules P1	AI agent (Nova Lite) P2	AI agent + guardrail P2g	Ceiling P*
single-cause failure	20	30 %	95 %	100 %	100 %	100 %
compound failure	48	2 % [0, 6]	62 % [48, 75]	85 % [75, 94]	88 % [77, 96]	88 % [77, 96]
all recoverable	68	10 %	72 % [62, 82]	90 % [82, 96]	91 % [84, 97]	91 % [84, 97]
Instruction cites a measured number and has no wrong number or claim	all decisions		91 % [88, 94]	54 % [47, 61]	99 % [98, 100]	
Decision breaks a hard rule of the prompt	all decisions		24 % [18, 30]	19 % [15, 24]	0 %	

Source for every cell: `eval/results/agent_ablation.md` (headline table and Addendum B). Paired differences on compound episodes: P2g minus P1 is +25.0 points, 95 % CI [+12.5, +37.5], so for the first time the lower end clears the pre-registered +10 bar; P2 minus P1 was +22.9 [+8.3, +37.5]; P2g minus P2 is +2.1 [-10.4, +14.6], no detectable change in recovery.

How to read it. P2's prompt was tuned on a separate dev set, and the label rule written as plain code (P*) reaches 88 %. With the prompt's own rules enforced by code, P2g's action matches the label set in 100 % of decisions on uncertified captures (P2 81 %), so its recovery equals P*. That shows guardrail plus LLM wording, not better reasoning than a good rule set; and 0 % rule violations is by construction, because the checker and P* share their source. What the guardrail changed clearly is the text and the rule-keeping. The first answer had a violation in 58 % of decisions; the re-ask fixed 21 % of all decisions; 36 % got the rules wording instead (the model's action was kept); 1 % had an action that stayed invalid and went to the rules policy. The model's own sentence is therefore the one the operator reads in about two thirds of decisions. The faithfulness check is automated; the human 1 to 5 rating was not done. Cost of the P2g test run: 392 model calls for 250 decisions, US$0.06, median call latency about 1.0 s (US$0.0719 for all Addendum B work; P2 with prompt iteration US$0.061, 419 calls).

Claude Haiku 4.5 (P3) was not evaluated. Bedrock refused every call because the AWS account has not submitted Anthropic's model use-case form, so P3 produced no results, and the live model is Nova Lite. Nothing in this section says anything about Claude models.

Limits of the study, all in `agent_ablation.md`: the simulator's failure distributions are assumptions (the real panel has no glare or severe tilt), the operator is cooperative, one cheap model, about 100 episodes, one annotator, no human rating of instruction text, and the study predates the two-tier gate and used the legacy-gate prompt, not the live CRC-gate prompt, whose guardrail checks are covered by unit tests only (`tests/test_guardrail.py`).

7 AWS delivery

Service	Role	Setting
EC2 c8g.large (Graviton4), Ubuntu 24.04, COOL AMI	FastAPI service, measurement	Elastic IP; rollback box t4g.small (`rollback_t4g.sh`)
Caddy	TLS	Let's Encrypt on <ip>.sslip.io
S3	evidence images (faces blurred), deploy bundles	public access blocked, SSE-AES256
DynamoDB prohori-traces	every step, joint history, approvals	on-demand, SSE, 90-day TTL
SNS prohori-escalations	engineer e-mail with review link	KMS-encrypted topic
Bedrock (Converse API)	LLM policy	numbers only in, one forced tool call; Nova Lite (`us.amazon.nova-lite-v1:0`), then Nova Micro, then rules; guardrail on; cap 200 decisions per day; Claude Haiku 4.5 not evaluated
CloudWatch	logs (14-day retention), metric filters (latency p50 and p95, tier counts, 5xx), dashboard Prohori-Service, alarm prohori-5xx to SNS	`infra/observability.sh`
Budgets	USD 25 per month, alerts at 50, 80, 100 %	`infra/up.sh`

Security. The instance role is least-privilege: `bedrock:InvokeModel` on Claude and Nova profiles only; DynamoDB put, query and get on one table; `sns:Publish` on one topic; `s3:PutObject` under `evidence/*` and `s3:GetObject` under `deploy/*`; log writes to one log group. Instance metadata requires IMDSv2, the EBS volume is encrypted, ports 80 and 443 are open and SSH is limited to one /24 of the operator's address (`infra/up.sh`). Uploads are capped at 15 MB, 30 requests per minute per IP, 200 LLM decisions per day. Every frame is scanned with YuNet; faces are blurred in the copy that is drawn on, returned and stored; if the detector is missing, nothing is stored. Redaction reduces risk and is not anonymisation (`research/SERVICE_NOTES.md`). Known gap: `GET /api/trace/<session>` is unauthenticated.

Observability. Every agent step (observation, gate, decision, rationale, model, tokens, latency) is stored in DynamoDB and shown in the app's Agent trace panel; the service writes structured JSON access lines that a journald forwarder sends to CloudWatch.

Repeatability. All scripts are idempotent bash with the AWS CLI: `up.sh` (budget, S3, DynamoDB, SNS, role, security group, Elastic IP, t4g.small), `observability.sh`, `cool_live.sh up | verify | cutover` (launch the COOL instance, POST every demo sample to the old and the new box and compare tiers and widths to 0.005 mm, then move the Elastic IP, rolling back by itself on failure), `push.sh` (ship the committed HEAD and restart), `rollback_t4g.sh`. `infra/state.env` holds the ids of the live resources; `up.sh` and `cool_live.sh` generate it, and it is not in the repository. The live `/health` (fetched 2026-10-26) reports `"opencv":"5.1.0-dev","cool":true`, `aarch64`, `c8g.large`, version `b3e9907`.

Cost. Two studies, counted separately. The COOL benchmark study used 2.198 instance-hours, about USD 0.37 (`eval/results/cool/ledger.tsv`). The developer-agent loop used 2.66 c8g.xlarge instance-hours (`eval/results/cool_agentloop/README.md`). The live box costs USD 0.0898 per hour (c8g.large plus the USD 0.01 COOL fee), about USD 2.15 per day at list price (`cool/20261025T002750Z/REPORT.md` section 4). The Nova Lite ablation, including prompt iteration, cost USD 0.061 for 419 calls; the guardrail runs (Addendum B) cost USD 0.0719 for 519 calls (`eval/results/agent_ablation.md`). At the Nova Lite list prices in the pre-registration (USD 0.06 and 0.24 per million input and output tokens) and the 7,840 input and 91 output tokens of the exhibit's re-asked step, one decision costs about USD 0.0005 (our arithmetic), so the 200-decision daily cap bounds the LLM cost near USD 0.1 per day.

8 COOL on Graviton4

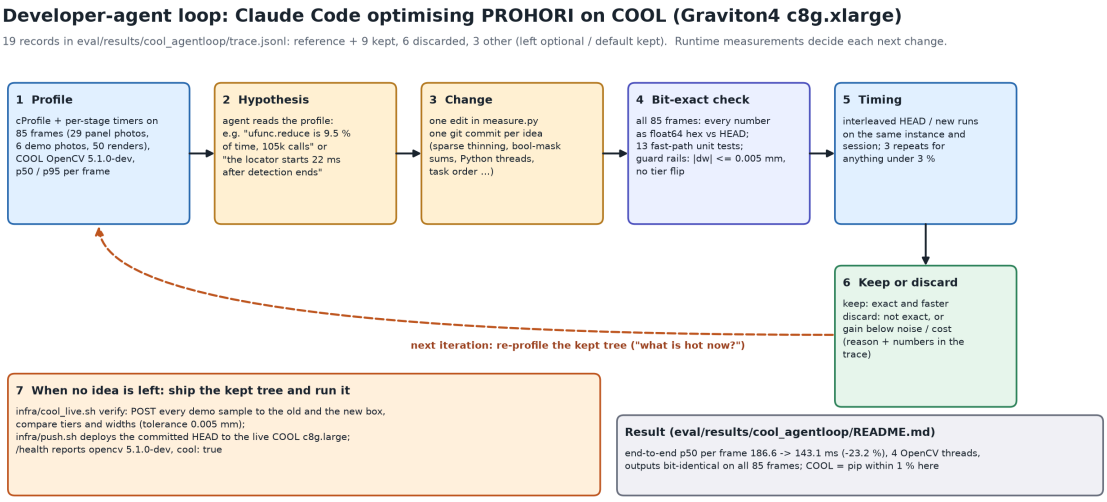
What was achieved. The COOL AMI (OpenCV 5.1.0-dev, KleidiCV 0.7.0 HAL; Marketplace AMI `ami-033e481a24f94c8cb`) runs PROHORI's full core workload on Graviton4: decode, ChArUco detection, homography, rectification, locator, full-resolution ROI warps, width estimators and gate, for all 85 test frames on c8g.large, c8g.xlarge and c8g.2xlarge. The live endpoint serves requests from COOL on a c8g.large. A developer agent then profiled the pipeline on COOL and made it 23.2 % faster at 4 OpenCV threads and 13.0 % cheaper per 1,000 frames at saturation, with bit-identical output.

Verified on the box (`cool/20261025T002750Z/REPORT.md` section 1; live `/health`): OpenCV **5.1.0-dev**, Release `-O3 -mcpu=neoverse-v2`, pthreads, HAL carotene 0.0.1 and KleidiCV 0.7.0, libjpeg-turbo 3.1.2, GCC 13.3.0, build timestamp 2026-07-13, IMDSv2 confirmed instance type and AMI id. We state no COOL release number: the AMI has no version file, so we report only the build information it shows. It ships no opencv_contrib, so the code does not use `cv2.ximgproc`.

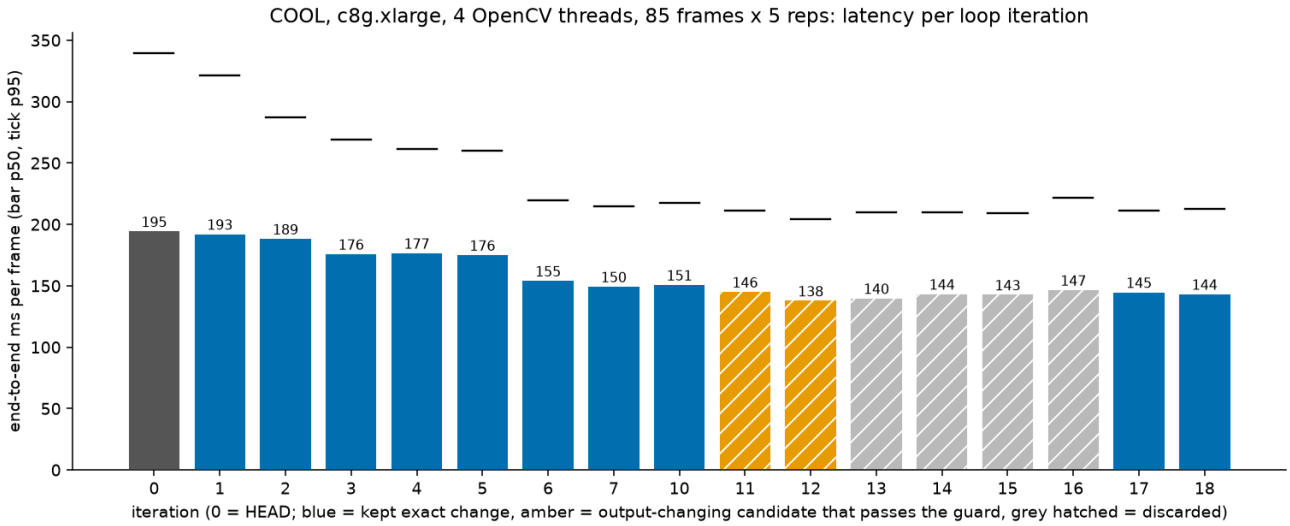
Invariance. COOL widths are not bitwise identical to the pip wheel: 154 of 220 cracks differ at 0.0001 mm, maximum 0.030 mm, P99 0.015 mm, 1 borderline certification flip in 220 cracks. Two plain builds of the same 5.0.0 source with different compilers differ by the same amount, the error against truth is the same in every build (mean 0.1218 mm pip, 0.1219 mm COOL), and a self-built 5.0.0 and a self-built 5.1-dev snapshot are bitwise identical.

Crash and workaround. `cv2.connectedComponentsWithStats` (default SPAGHETTI) aborts the process with glibc heap corruption on COOL as soon as OpenCV uses 2 or more threads: 50 of 50 runs at 2 and at 4 threads, 0 of 50 at 1 thread; pip, self-built and upstream snapshot builds 0 of 50 everywhere. The AMI's default thread count is the vCPU count, so the first frame crashes at default settings. Routing the call to `CCL_BBDT` gives identical labels and stats on all 63 masks and lets COOL run at 4 threads. The code uses BBDT. A draft bug report and repro are in `cool/20261025T002750Z/bug_connectedcomponents/`; it was not sent anywhere.

Developer-agent loop. An agent (Claude Code) iterated on `measure.py`: profile, hypothesis, one change per commit, bit-exact check of every number on all 85 frames, interleaved timing on one instance, keep or discard with the numbers recorded (`trace.jsonl`, 19 records). It kept 9 of 18 candidate changes; 6 were discarded and 3 were left optional or at the default.



Developer-agent loop



Latency per iteration

COOL, c8g.xlarge, 85 frames	Before (HEAD)	After (kept changes)
End-to-end p50 per frame, 4 OpenCV threads	186.6 ms	**143.1 ms (-23.2 %)**
p95 per frame, 4 threads	324 ms	208 ms
p50, 1 OpenCV thread	307.2 ms	225.7 ms (-26.5 %)
USD per 1,000 frames, 4 processes x 1 thread	0.00393	**0.00342 (-13.0 %)**
Output against HEAD		bit-identical on 85 frames

An output-changing resize change (-29.2 % against HEAD) passed its guard but was left off `main` to keep outputs bit-identical.

COOL against pip after optimisation (same instance, same code, same session; `cool_agentloop/README.md`):

	pip 5.0.0.93	COOL	pip / COOL
4 threads, p50 after the loop	142.2 ms	143.0 ms	**0.994x (tie)**
1 thread, p50 after the loop	224.3 ms	225.7 ms	0.994x
USD per 1,000 frames, best config	0.00319	0.00342	COOL **+7.2 %**

The gains of the loop apply to the pip build as well (188.9 to 142.2 ms, -24.7 %). The reason is Amdahl: OpenCV calls are 67 % of `analyze()` time and the dominant ones (INTER_AREA resize, ArUco detection, `warpPerspective`) are not the ones KleidiCV accelerates. Where COOL does win, it is exact: `medianBlur` 2.4x, `erode` 1.75x, `distanceTransform` 1.65x. One KleidiCV path is slower: `warpPerspective` INTER_LINEAR runs at 0.56x. Before the loop, the end-to-end ratio at 1 thread was 1.014x [1.010, 1.017] (`cool/20261025T002750Z/REPORT.md`); with the fee, COOL cost +6.8 % per 1,000 frames on c8g.xlarge at list price.

Cost, stated plainly. At list price the USD 0.01 per hour COOL fee makes COOL 7.2 % dearer than the pip wheel per 1,000 frames at equal throughput. The fee is waived during the 7-day trial and may not be payable with promotional credits. For this workload COOL is a correct, supported Arm runtime and not a speed or cost win. The measured value is the developer-agent loop (latency, cost, bit-exact checks), the invariance ladder, and the multithreading crash with its workaround.

9 Evaluation summary

#	Quantity	Value	Protocol	Source file
E1	Width MAE, all gate states	0.070 mm [0.048, 0.098]	63 cracks, 8 held-out panel photos	eval/results/width_eval.md
E2	Width MAE, cracks passing the gate	0.056 mm [0.042, 0.074]	41 cracks	width_eval.md
E3	Width MAE, under 0.5 mm	0.055 mm [0.035, 0.077]	16 cracks	width_eval.md
E4	Width MAE, renders	0.098 mm [0.080, 0.119]	162 cracks, exact truth	width_eval.md
E5	Width P95, all / passing	0.209 / 0.143 mm	same sets	width_eval.md
E6	Under-read, 2.0 / 3.0 mm strokes	-0.162 / -0.144 mm	bias on TEST	width_eval.md
E7	Certified (green) tier	3.2 % wrong, 25.8 % of cracks pass, risk 0.74 %	100 grouped splits	eval/results/gate_report.md
E8	Amber level (green or amber pass)	11.5 % wrong, 38.7 % pass, risk 4.30 %	100 grouped splits	gate_report.md
E9	Splits with risk within alpha	69 of 100 (0.05), 76 of 100 (0.01)		gate_report.md
E10	90 % interval coverage	91.5 % (passing 91.8 %), half-width 0.179 mm; 0.3 mm bin 86.3 %, others at least 89.5 %	held-out groups	gate_report.md
E11	Leave-one-photo-out, original photos	53.6 % pass, 10.0 % of those wrong	168 cracks	gate_report.md
E12	Recovery in 3 actions, compound, P1 / P2 / P2g / P*	62 / 85 / 88 / 88 %	48 simulated episodes	eval/results/agent_ablation.md
E13	Compound recovery, paired differences	P2g - P1 +25.0 points [+12.5, +37.5]; P2g - P2 +2.1 [-10.4, +14.6]; P2 - P1 +22.9 [+8.3, +37.5]	paired by episode	agent_ablation.md
E14	Instruction faithfulness, P1 / P2 / P2g; hard-rule violations	91 / 54 / 99 %; 24 / 19 / 0 %	automated check, all decisions; Claude Haiku 4.5 not evaluated	agent_ablation.md
E15	Trace: px/mm and decision	2.71 to 7.98; move_closer to accept	live endpoint	docs/TRACE_EXHIBIT.md
E16	COOL against pip, p50, 4 threads, after loop	0.994x (tie)	85 frames, c8g.xlarge	eval/results/cool_agentloop/README.md
E17	COOL against pip, end to end, 1 thread, before loop	1.014x [1.010, 1.017]	85 frames, c8g.xlarge	eval/results/cool/20261025T002750Z/REPORT.md
E18	COOL widths against pip	max 0.030 mm, 1 flip in 220	invariance ladder	cool/20261025T002750Z/REPORT.md

#	Quantity	Value	Protocol	Source file
E19	COOL crash with 2 or more threads	50 of 50 runs	default CCL	`cool/20261025T002750Z/REPORT.md`
E20	Developer loop, p50 / cost per 1,000 frames	-23.2 % / -13.0 %	bit-identical on 85 frames	`cool_agentloop/README.md`
E21	COOL fee premium per 1,000 frames	+7.2 % (after loop; +6.8 % before)	list prices	`cool_agentloop/README.md`, `cool/.../REPORT.md`
E22	Instance-hours	2.198 h (benchmark), 2.66 h (loop)	separate studies	`eval/results/cool/ledger.tsv`, `cool_agentloop/README.md`
E23	Test suite	310 passed	`python -m pytest -q`, Windows, 103 s, 2026-10-26	run at commit 02704a0

10 Failure cases and limitations

Nine cases were run against the live endpoint with both policies (`docs/FAILURE_GALLERY.md`). It works as built for: too far (2.71 px/mm, refused, `move_closer`); board out of frame (0 corners, no number, `reposition_marker`); extreme tilt of 66.6 degrees (refused, `oblique`). It does **not** refuse in these cases: mild blur (the capture is certified (green) through one wide crack, with a wide interval, while 7 of 8 are flagged); a real photo at 42 degrees tilt with blur (amber for 1 of 4 cracks); synthetic glare of 4 % and 12 % (the capture passes, because the learned gate has no glare threshold). Before the guardrail the LLM chose `reposition_marker` for a heavily blurred frame where its own prompt says `reshoot_steadier` and sometimes cited a wrong number; the guardrail now catches both, and the gallery was re-recorded with it.

- **One sheet, one phone, one session.** No real concrete crack has been measured against a microscope; a real crack edge is less defined than a printed stroke.
- **Targets not met.** MAE 0.070 mm against the 0.05 mm target; thin cracks did not improve; 2 and 3 mm strokes are under-read by about 0.15 mm.
- **Small calibration set** (21 photo groups); the guarantee is empirical (section 5).
- **The gate is per crack**, so a capture can count as certified through its widest crack; read each crack's own tier and interval.
- **The agent study is a simulation** (section 6). The live LLM prompt is not the one measured, the 0 % rule violations hold by construction, and Claude Haiku 4.5 was not evaluated.
- **COOL is a tie** here, costs 7.2 % more at list price, is not bitwise identical, and its default multithreaded component labelling crashes.
- **Requirements on the user:** a printed board at 100 % scale lying flat in the crack's plane, a camera with focus, 20 to 45 cm distance. Thin cracks (0.3 to 0.5 mm) need about 10 to 20 px/mm to pass.
- **No crack re-identification across visits**; the operator names the joint (the earlier LightGlue plan was not built).
- The classical locator finds almost nothing on raw textured asphalt or concrete (crack IoU 0.00 on four of the public sets, `eval/results/seg_baseline_findings.md`); it is tuned for a rectified page and is not a general crack detector.

11 Responsible use

PROHORI gives a width, how far to trust it, and what to do next. It gives no safety verdict, and every escalation message says so. A qualified engineer decides. Faces are blurred before anything is stored, and nothing is stored if the detector is unavailable. DynamoDB rows expire after 90 days; evidence images are private and encrypted. The approval step is a human act by design. The tool is a guide to durability reference values and must not be used to clear an occupied building. Real cracks do not change measurably in a few weeks, so the change-over-time view is demonstrated on a physically modified test panel and labelled that way; seeded history rows are never shown as observed growth (`research/SERVICE_NOTES.md`).

12 Reproducibility

```
git clone https://github.com/hozaifa1/prohori.git && cd prohori
python -m venv .venv && . .venv/bin/activate     # Python 3.12; Windows Git Bash: . .venv/Scripts/activate
pip install -r requirements-test.txt && pip install -r requirements-eval.txt
python -m pytest -q                              # 310 passed at commit 02704a0; AWS mocked with moto
uvicorn service.app:app --port 8000              # local service
gh release download v1.0-submission -R hozaifa1/prohori -p "prohori-*.zip" -p SHA256SUMS.txt
sha256sum -c SHA256SUMS.txt && unzip -o prohori-panel-data-v1.zip && unzip -o prohori-agent-ablation-v1.zip
python eval/gate_fit.py --stage out/gate         # gate report from committed features
python eval/agent_ablation.py report             # agent tables from the agent bundle
python eval/cool_loop_report.py                  # developer-loop tables and figure
bash infra/up.sh && bash infra/cool_live.sh up   # AWS deploy (own account)
```

OpenCV is pinned to `opencv-contrib-python-headless==5.0.0.93` for every result except the COOL runs. The release `v1.0-submission` holds `prohori-panel-data-v1.zip` (89,874,441 bytes, sha256 `39bb139dc2bffaceb094036688949b18c80bca7c04eec7c0bbe945f3fcd30a9f`: 29 panel photos, gate-calibration manifests, frozen splits, render config) and `prohori-agent-ablation-v1.zip` (700,497 bytes, sha256 `c264e8a820d75d9cbb195a56ea9c74b9c1dae45206ef3af5e3d0b23fa3edca75`: episode logs including P2g, LLM ledger, prompts, pre-registration hashes). The table of commands per result is in the README. The width evaluation cannot be fully reproduced from the bundle (the 500 renders are 1.1 GB and the krkCMd profile data is separate); the panel, gate, agent and COOL results can. The COOL runs need a c8g instance and the Marketplace AMI.

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